

## Gangnam style #1 on Youtube

With over 800 million views, PSY's "Gangnam Style" overtook Justin Bieber's "Baby" to become the most watched video on YouTube



## Gmail's security tightened

Google tightened security on its Gmail service after a researcher exploited a security loophole to send spoof emails to the founders



Windows 8 operating system has a very different user interface and works with gestures

things that work best with the mouse and keyboard, like the traditional desktop.

Microsoft has done away with Basic, Home, Ultimate versions that we'd seen in Windows 7 and instead put out versions that will run on different hardware.

### Windows RT

This is a version of the Windows 8 OS that will work on ARM powered devices such as tablets. The biggest downside to this version is that it will not run legacy apps. Put simply, the device will only run those apps that are available through the app store on the device. So if you want to run a third party browser or a video player, you can rest assured that it won't work. The RT version of Windows won't run x86 programs.

The advantage of Windows RT is that it is relatively easy for developers to port apps that run on Windows Phone 8 and make them run on Windows RT. This is easier said than done though. Remember how some of the iPhone apps were

stretched when they ran on the iPad? We hope Microsoft will fix this and not simply import the apps.

### Windows 8

Then there is the x86 version of the OS, which is essentially the desktop version, which will run on Intel or AMD, powered laptops, desktops or the laptop/tablet hybrids that have started to emerge. This version will run all applications/programs, that are available via the Windows Marketplace as well as those that can be downloaded from third party websites. Windows 8 Pro is another flavour of Windows 8, with the only difference being that Pro has the following three features: joining a domain, encrypting your disk with BitLocker and being able to log into your PC remotely.

Microsoft has gone all out with revamping the OS to the point that certain keyboard shortcuts too have changed. Hitting the Windows key on the keyboard no longer opens the start menu, but launches the Start screen. Only time will tell if this move is for the better and from what we have seen, customers are slightly resistant to change, especially since Windows 7 still is a really good and reliable OS.

## The year in sequels (Good)

2012 has been quite a good year for gaming, especially if you are a gamer

in India. The year has seen its share of gaming hardware as well as software launches. Sony finally succumbed to fan pressure and unveiled the PS Vita last year but the device hit the Indian shores in February 2012 and what a treat it was! Not only did it add a second analog stick, but also front and rear touch panels to add a better gaming experience. The end of the year has also seen the launch of the Wii U, the first next-gen console, but unfortunately, Nintendo doesn't officially launch its consoles in India.

The year has also seen a slew of games hit store shelves. Like the past few years, we have seen 2012 release more sequels that big budget AAA new IP's. Games that hit store shelves included *Max Payne 3*, *Hitman Absolution*, *Call of Duty Black Ops 2*, *Assassins Creed 3*, *Borderlands 2*, *Darksiders 2*, *Halo 4*, *Transformers: Fall of Cybertron*, *Resident Evil 6*, *Need for Speed: Most Wanted*, *Forza Horizon* and a whole lot more.

If you thought that paying a whopping ₹2,500 for a console game was bad, you may want to consider becoming a PC gamer as PC games are available for



Wii U was the successor to the Wii launched six years ago

a mere ₹999. On the other hand, some games on the PC have become free to play. Even before *Crysis 3* hits store shelves, Crytech has said that it is planning a free to play *Crysis*. Crytech has been quite open about making its games free-to-play or renting them out to gamers so that more gamers who cannot afford to pay full retail get access to AAA titles. One of the biggest titles to go free to play in 2012 was *Star Wars: The Old Republic*.

OnLive, as a game-streaming service seemed like a great idea on paper but practically didn't seem to take-off. The idea was that users could purchase a bare bones console and could stream the



Microsoft Surface sporting Windows RT